



**moral
realism**



moral
nihilism

A solid green circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text "moral relativism" in white, bold, sans-serif font.

**moral
relativism**

We can, unsurprisingly, turn this into an argument against moral relativism of the sort we have already considered:

But there is also a kind of general lesson here. Some of the figures we most admire in history were, like Douglass, advocates for moral views which went against the views of the societies of which they were a part. But according to the moral relativist who say that moral claims are claims about what one's society approves of, such 'moral pioneers' will always be getting things wrong. There is thus a sense in which moral relativism is a profoundly conservative position: it always validates the moral view of the majority in a society.

1. If moral relativism is true, then those who spoke in favor of slavery in mid-19th century America spoke truly, and those who spoke against it spoke falsely.
2. It is not the case that those who spoke in favor of slavery in mid-19th century America spoke truly, and those who spoke against it spoke falsely.

C. Moral relativism is false. (1,2)

THE ARGUMENT FROM UNPOPULAR BUT TRUE VIEWS
ABOUT RIGHT AND WRONG

We can, unsurprisingly, turn this into an argument against moral

relativism of the sort we have already considered:

views of the societies which they were a part. But according to the moral

of, such 'moral pioneers' will always be getting things wrong. There is thus a sense

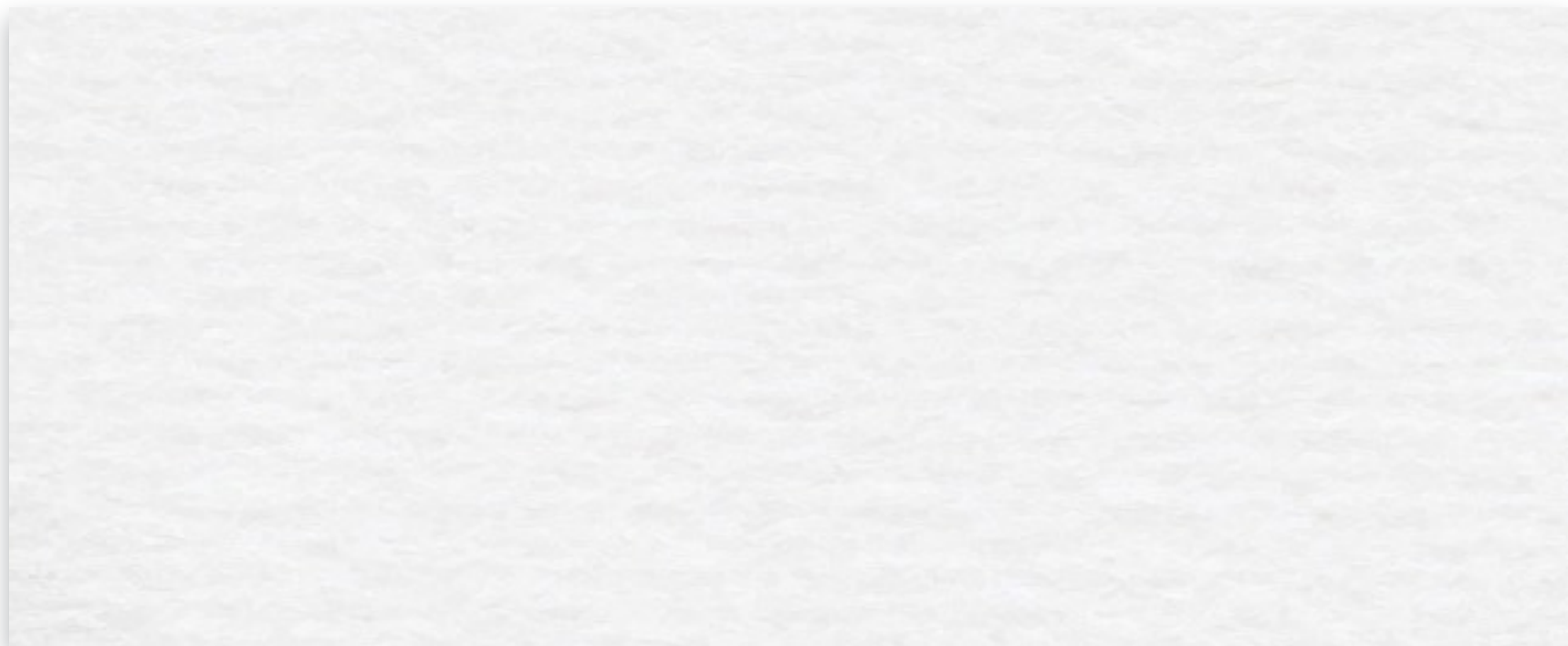
relativist who say that moral claims are about what one's society approves

But there is also a kind of general less on here. Some of the figures we most admire

in history were, like Douglas, advocates for moral views which went against the

in which moral relativism is a profoundly conservative position: it always validates

the moral view of the majority in a society.



against it spitefully.

spoke in favor of slavery in mid-19th century

1. If moral relativism is true, then those who

favor slavery in mid-19th century America

people truly, and those who spoke against it

2. It is not the case that those who spoke in

C. Moral relativism is false. (1,2)

spoke if allseely.



America speaks truly, and those who speak





**moral
nihilism**



**moral
relativism**